



AMNESTY INTERNATIONAL
AOTEAROA NEW ZEALAND

HUMAN RIGHTS DAO

Pilot impact and closeout report

CARDANO PROJECT CATALYST · Fund 13 · Project 1300018
FINAL MILESTONE 4 · Evaluation and future pathways · May 2026

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CONTENTS

- 1** Executive summary
 - 2** About the project
 - 3** What we set out to do
 - 4** Milestone delivery summary
 - 5** The pilot: what 36 people told us
 - 6** Governance and token design evaluation
 - 7** Technical evaluation of the MVP
 - 8** What we learned
 - 9** What we did not deliver, and why
 - 10** Digital resilience and the road ahead
 - 11** Comparators and the wider field
 - 12** Results: KPIs, outputs, outcomes and impact
 - 13** Conclusion
 - A** Evidence and repository index
 - B** Pilot feedback dashboard
 - C** Tiered hardware and software kit
 - D** References and acknowledgements
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1 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Human Rights DAO pilot successfully demonstrated the governance and participation concepts it set out to test. It shipped on Cardano, it was tested by real people across four regions, and it answered the question Catalyst asked us to answer: can a global human rights movement use decentralised governance to give its supporters a real, rewarded voice? The answer is yes, with conditions.

Between January and March 2026, thirty-six participants across Aotearoa New Zealand, Australia, the European Union and Asia used the HRDAO minimum viable product. They created and voted on proposals, earned and spent tokens, and told us in detail what worked and what did not. The headline numbers are clear: 83 percent rated the experience smooth or intuitive, 78 percent said they would use a refined version, and 61 percent raised thoughtful concerns about governance. That last number matters as much as the first two. It tells us the people who tested the system engaged with it at the level the system actually requires.

This is the closeout report for the final milestone of the project. It does three things. It evaluates the pilot with the real data behind it. It sets out what we learned, including what we did not finish. And it maps the road ahead — a next phase built around digital resilience, open-source infrastructure, and hardware that the movement and its supporters genuinely own.

THE THREE DECISIONS THAT SHAPE THE NEXT PHASE

Own the intelligence. The next phase moves the platform's AI layer to local, open-weight models that run on a participant's own device or on infrastructure the movement controls, rather than depending on third-party services whose data handling cannot be audited. A human rights tool should route human rights data through systems that are not only open to inspection, but are also accountable to the people and communities whose rights they are intended to protect.

Anchor on Cardano, stay open everywhere else. The rights and settlement layer runs on Cardano, where its research-led design is genuinely the right fit. The participation, storage, identity and communications layers are deliberately built to be portable, so the project is never captured by any single platform.

Build for resilience, publish the playbook. Privacy, security and hardware guidance — including guidance for high-risk participants — is documented openly, in the tradition of Access Now, Internews and the Electronic Frontier Foundation. Withholding security knowledge does not protect the people who need it.

None of these are abstract. Each one translates into specific tools, specific hardware, and specific design choices set out in the body of this report. The pilot successfully demonstrated the concept. The next phase is about building the resilience, trust, and infrastructure required to operate it at the standard a global human rights movement deserves.

2 ABOUT THE PROJECT

Amnesty International is a movement of more than ten million people in over seventy countries, bound by a single idea: that ordinary people, acting together, can defend the human rights of others. The movement has always experimented with the tools of its time, from the letter-writing campaigns that freed prisoners of conscience to the digital organising of today.

The Human Rights DAO project asked whether the governance tools emerging from the Cardano ecosystem could serve that movement. A DAO — a decentralised autonomous organisation — is a way of making decisions together, transparently, with rules written in software and participation open to everyone who holds a stake. The proposal, funded under Cardano Project Catalyst Fund 13 as Project 1300018, set out to build a proof of concept: a platform where Amnesty supporters could propose, deliberate, vote, and be recognised for their contribution, all on open infrastructure.

The project ran across four funded milestones. Milestone 1 produced the research and the governance whitepaper. Milestone 2 designed and simulated the token economy. Milestone 3 built and tested the working prototype. This document closes Milestone 4: the evaluation, the impact assessment, and the path forward. The full body of work — code, contracts, documentation, and evidence — is public and is indexed in Appendix A.

Two principles guided the work throughout. The first is that public-interest governance is not the same as speculative governance. A human rights DAO is not a vehicle for financial return; it is an instrument for participation, recognition, and collective decision-making in service of a mission. The second is that the infrastructure beneath a human rights tool must itself respect human rights — it must be sovereign, inspectable, and resistant to capture. The first principle shaped Milestones 1 through 3. The second principle is what Milestone 4 carries forward into the next phase.

The timing of this work is not incidental. Amnesty International's 2026 annual report, *The State of the World's Human Rights*, documents a year in which states across 144 countries deployed surveillance, artificial intelligence, facial recognition, spyware, internet shutdowns and censorship to silence dissent, warning of a predatory, anti-rights order taking hold. In a separate briefing published in May 2026, *Unlawful by Design*, Amnesty's Algorithmic Accountability Lab found that the data pipelines powering today's major generative AI systems are rooted in mass invasions of privacy by design. A movement responding to that landscape cannot build its own participation infrastructure on the same foundations it is documenting as harmful. The HRDAO project is, in part, an attempt to demonstrate that another way is buildable.

3 WHAT WE SET OUT TO DO

The Milestone 4 acceptance criteria, as published on the Catalyst platform, asked for a detailed evaluation report on the project's minimum viable product, combining quantitative and qualitative insight. Specifically, the criteria called for participant feedback, token design data, and reflection on inclusivity, transparency and overall user experience, alongside publication of the final impact report and the sharing of results across Amnesty's and Cardano's networks. This report meets each of those criteria directly; Appendix A maps the evidence to the requirement.

Beyond the formal criteria, the project set itself a harder test. The goal was never simply to prove that a DAO could be built. The harder question was whether decentralised governance could be made genuinely usable, genuinely inclusive, and genuinely aligned with a human rights mission, by people who are not crypto-native and who care about the cause rather than the technology. The pilot was designed to find that out.

The success measures we held ourselves to were therefore practical. Could a supporter who had never touched a blockchain understand the platform and use it with minimal onboarding? Did the act of participating feel meaningful, or did it feel like a gimmick? Did people see the risks as clearly as the opportunities? And would they come back? The pilot answered all four, and the answers are in Section 5.

4 MILESTONE DELIVERY SUMMARY

The project delivered four milestones over roughly eighteen months, moving from governance theory to economic design to a working, tested system. The table below summarises each; full outputs are indexed in Appendix A and held in the public repository.

OUTPUT		STATUS AND EVIDENCE
M1	Research & governance — whitepaper and analysis of decentralised governance models for human rights, including identity, privacy, multilingual participation, and guardian protocols for high-risk contexts.	Complete. Whitepaper published in the repository. Governance architecture mapped to Cardano's Voltaire model.
M2	Tokenomics — dual-token design (a transferable utility token and a non-transferable governance credential) with economic simulation, supply controls, and anti-gaming mechanisms.	Complete. Tokenomics model and technical report published, with simulation outputs.
M3	MVP & testing — working DAO prototype: proposal creation, voting, token rewards, contribution tracking, end-to-end user journeys, with load and baseline security testing.	Complete. Application, smart contracts, and test results in the repository. Pilot run with 36 participants.
M4	Evaluation — this report: pilot evaluation, impact assessment, lessons, and the next-phase architecture for digital resilience and participant infrastructure.	This document. Published to Catalyst and shared across Amnesty and Cardano networks.

Table 1. Milestone delivery summary.

Funds distributed to date: £125,000 of £150,000. Milestone 4 value: £25,000.

The build itself is worth naming, because it reflects deliberate choices. The smart contracts were written in Aiken and govern the on-chain logic of proposals, voting, and token allocation. The application layer consists of a mobile-first Vue front end supported by Gleam and TypeScript services with a PostgreSQL-backed state store. The platform was documented to support reproducibility and underwent functional testing, security review, and technical validation during development to assess readiness for pilot deployment. These were not arbitrary. Aiken gives auditable, formally-grounded contracts; the mobile-first Vue front end is what let non-technical supporters use the system without friction; and the storage choices keep the door open to censorship-resistant permanence in the next phase.

KPI SUMMARY

The table below summarises the principal outputs, outcomes and indicators generated during the Human Rights DAO pilot.

Metric	Result
Catalyst Project ID	1300018
Milestones Delivered	4 of 4
Governance Whitepaper	Completed
Tokenomics Model & Simulations	Completed
Smart Contract Architecture	Completed
MVP Prototype	Completed
Regions Tested	4
Pilot Participants	36

Metric	Result
User Experience Rated Smooth or Intuitive	83%
Would Use Refined Version	78%
Raised Governance Design Considerations	61%
Public Repository Published	Yes
Open Source Documentation Published	Yes
Final Evaluation Report	Completed

These indicators demonstrate successful delivery of all major project outputs and provide evidence of user engagement, governance participation, and platform viability for future development.

DELIVERY AGAINST ORIGINAL CATALYST OBJECTIVES

Original Objective	Outcome
Research decentralised governance models for human rights applications	Completed through governance whitepaper and comparative analysis
Design a Human Rights Token model	Completed through dual-token architecture and simulation modelling
Test token sustainability and governance dynamics	Completed through modelling, scenario testing, and stress simulations
Build a functional MVP DAO prototype	Completed and tested across four regions
Enable proposal creation, voting, and participation	Completed within MVP pilot environment
Gather stakeholder and participant feedback	Completed with 36 pilot participants
Publish open-source outputs	Completed through GitHub repository and documentation
Produce final evaluation and recommendations	Completed through this report
The project successfully achieved all primary objectives established in the original Catalyst proposal while generating additional insights into governance design, digital resilience, and human rights participation systems.	

5 THE PILOT: WHAT 36 PEOPLE TOLD US

A pilot cohort of around forty Amnesty participants engaged with the platform between January and March 2026. Thirty-six gave structured feedback across usability, governance, and overall experience. They were Amnesty staff, youth advocates, activists, and supporters, drawn from Aotearoa New Zealand, Australia, the European Union and Asia. What follows is what they actually said.

5.1 IT DID NOT FEEL LIKE CRYPTO

The single most important result is that the platform did not feel like a blockchain product. It felt like an Amnesty product. Participants moved from onboarding through to participation without significant friction, and the mobile-first design was praised consistently across every region.

The app overall is so simple and straightforward — you understand the process even without a tutorial.

— MATTEO, PILOT PARTICIPANT

One participant offered the strategic lesson the whole project should carry forward: the language of the technology gets in the way of the purpose of the technology.

I suggest not mentioning the term ‘decentralised’ — most people don’t understand what blockchain means in this context.

— DAVID, PILOT PARTICIPANT

This is not a small point. It validates a sequence of design choices made across Milestones 2 and 3: separating the utility token from the governance credential so participants were not forced to think in financial terms, wrapping the Cardano interactions inside a familiar mobile interface rather than exposing wallet mechanics, and aligning the visual design tightly with Amnesty’s own identity. The result was a participant telling us the platform “very much feels like an Amnesty product in terms of design.”

5.2 PARTICIPATION FELT MEANINGFUL

The second result is that the core loop — take an action, receive recognition, see your standing — worked as intended. Participants described it as motivating rather than gimmicky.

The immediate granting of tokens after a completed action gives a gratifying feeling that has real potential.

— ANNE, PILOT PARTICIPANT

The balance dashboard makes tracking live points feel rewarding, encouraging ongoing interaction.

— TOM, PILOT PARTICIPANT

Carlo named precisely what the model is for: a way to make a supporter’s engagement legible, both to themselves and to the movement.

Having the ability to receive and spend tokens gives a quantitative measure of engagement I find genuinely compelling.

— CARLO, PILOT PARTICIPANT

Seventy-eight percent of respondents said they would use a refined version of the platform. For an early-stage prototype tested by people with no obligation to like it, that is a strong signal of genuine demand for participatory, transparent forms of involvement in the movement’s decisions.

5.3 THEY SURFACED THE RIGHT PROBLEMS

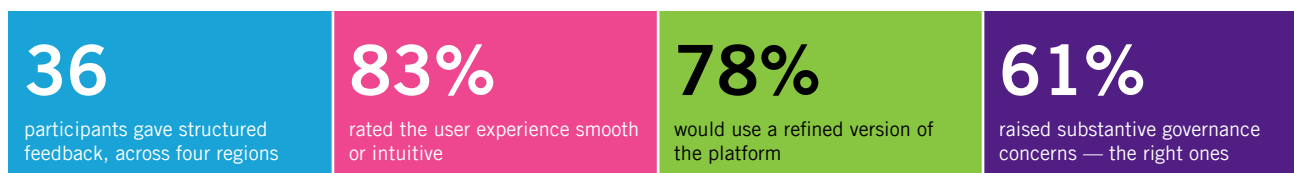
The third result is the one that gives this cohort its credibility. Sixty-one percent of participants raised governance concerns — not interface complaints, not technical glitches, but substantive questions about fairness, influence, and mission alignment. These are the questions a professional governance designer would ask.

A small number of users gaining a large number of DAO points could have an outsized influence on decision making.

— NISHAD, PILOT PARTICIPANT

Other participants asked what would happen if a coordinated group used the DAO to push an agenda contrary to Amnesty’s values, and how the system could uphold the views of people with lived experience of the issues at stake. One asked directly how to ensure participation remained fair when not everyone can attend events or protests. These concerns are not weaknesses in the pilot. They are the agenda for the next phase, and they confirm that the central challenge ahead is governance design, not technology.

THE PILOT IN FOUR NUMBERS



5.4 THE HONEST COUNTER-STORY

A credible evaluation reports what did not land as well. Three things recurred. First, spending tokens was less clear than earning them; the value flow needs to be more visible. Second, the concept itself needs explaining — participants were clear that the idea of a DAO is unfamiliar and that onboarding must teach it gently. Third, while the mobile-first design was a strength, participants asked for a web version to remove the app-download barrier and for richer, more dynamic interaction over time. None of these are structural failures. They are the refinement list for a system whose foundations are sound.

6 GOVERNANCE AND TOKEN DESIGN EVALUATION

The token model designed in Milestone 2 held up under the scrutiny of real participants. Its central choice — two distinct tokens with distinct purposes — proved to be the right one, and it is the reason the pilot avoided the trap that catches most governance experiments.

6.1 TWO TOKENS, TWO JOBS

The architecture separates a transferable utility token, used to recognise and reward participation, from a non-transferable governance credential that carries voting weight and reputation. The governance credential cannot be bought or sold. This matters because it directly addresses the concern Nishad and others raised: if influence could simply be purchased, the wealthy would govern a human rights movement, which is the opposite of the point. By making governance weight a function of contribution and reputation rather than capital, the design keeps the door to influence tied to participation in the cause.

The Milestone 2 model also built in the controls a living economy needs: a measured supply policy, deflationary mechanisms tied to genuine activity, staking to reward sustained engagement, vesting to align long-term contributors, and explicit anti-gaming safeguards. An emergency provision allows the community to respond to humanitarian crises through a high-threshold collective decision. The genesis allocation deliberately weights the community above all other categories. The full parameter set is summarised in Appendix B and documented in the published tokenomics report.

6.2 WHERE THE DESIGN NOW NEEDS TO EVOLVE

The pilot identified two design pressures that the next phase must resolve. The first is concentration of influence. Even with a non-transferable governance credential, a small number of highly active participants could accumulate disproportionate weight. The next phase will examine mechanisms drawn from plural and quadratic approaches, where breadth of support counts for more than intensity from a few. The second is value clarity: participants understood how to earn but found spending less obvious. The remedy is design work, not architecture change — clearer dashboards showing how participation translates into real-world outcomes, and an “impact” view that closes the loop between an action taken and a result achieved.

Would be good to include an ‘insights’ tab to see how tokens are used to drive impact.

— PILOT PARTICIPANT, ON CLOSING THE LOOP BETWEEN PARTICIPATION AND OUTCOME

7 TECHNICAL EVALUATION OF THE MVP

The minimum viable product is a working system, not a mock-up. It runs the full set of governance journeys end to end: onboarding, proposal creation, deliberation, voting, token rewards, and contribution tracking. The codebase, documentation, deployment configuration, and test results are public.

7.1 WHAT WAS BUILT

The smart contracts were written in Aiken and govern the on-chain logic of proposals, voting, and token allocation. The application layer consists of a mobile-first Vue front end supported by Gleam and TypeScript services with a PostgreSQL-backed state store. The platform was documented to support reproducibility and underwent functional testing, security review, and technical validation during development to assess readiness for pilot deployment. The architecture documentation in the repository describes the system constraints honestly, including the boundaries of what an MVP-stage deployment can be expected to support.

The decision to keep the blockchain invisible to the participant was a technical achievement as much as a design one. Cardano interactions are mediated through the application rather than exposed as wallet operations, which is the single largest reason the pilot cohort found the system usable with minimal onboarding. The eighty-three percent smooth-experience result is, in large part, a verdict on this engineering.

7.2 WHAT NEEDS HARDENING

The MVP is a proof of concept, and its limits are documented rather than hidden. Three areas need work before any wider deployment. Security needs to move from a baseline review to a full independent audit of the Aiken contracts and a penetration test of the application stack. Scalability needs genuine load testing against the scale a global movement implies, well beyond the pilot cohort. And the identity layer — the mechanism that proves a participant is a unique, real person without surveilling them — remains the hardest unsolved problem and the most important one for the next phase. Section 10 sets out the approach to each.

8 WHAT WE LEARNED

Five lessons carry forward from the pilot, each grounded in what participants told us rather than in what we hoped to hear.

8.1 LEAD WITH THE MISSION, NOT THE MECHANISM

David's advice to drop the word "decentralised" is the lesson in miniature. People came to the platform because they care about human rights, and they stayed because the platform let them act on that care. The technology should be felt, not seen. Every piece of language, every screen, every onboarding step in the next phase should pass a simple test: does this help a supporter act, or does this ask them to understand crypto first?

8.2 RECOGNITION IS THE ENGINE

The reward loop is what made participation feel real. The next phase should deepen it, not complicate it — making the link between an action and its consequence more visible, so that a supporter can see not just that they earned recognition but that their participation changed something.

8.3 THE HARD PROBLEM IS GOVERNANCE, NOT CODE

Sixty-one percent of participants raised governance concerns because governance is where the real risk lives. Capture, concentration, and misalignment with the movement's values are design problems that no amount of clever engineering solves on its own. The next phase treats governance design as the primary work, with structured deliberation upstream of formal voting so that the movement finds common ground before it settles decisions on-chain.

8.4 INCLUSION HAS TO BE DESIGNED IN

A participant warned that events and protests are not accessible to everyone, and that a system rewarding those activities risks rewarding the already-privileged. Inclusion cannot be an afterthought. The next phase must offer multiple, equally-valued paths to participation — including low-bandwidth, offline, and assisted routes — so that a supporter's circumstances do not determine their voice.

8.5 SOVEREIGNTY IS NOT OPTIONAL FOR A RIGHTS TOOL

The clearest strategic lesson sits beneath all the others. A tool built to defend human rights cannot quietly depend on infrastructure that surveils, censors, or is controlled by actors hostile to those rights. This realisation reshaped the next-phase architecture and is the subject of Section 10.

9 WHAT WE DID NOT DELIVER, AND WHY

A proof of concept earns trust by being honest about its edges. Three things were out of scope for the pilot and are named here plainly, because each is a precondition for any move toward wider deployment.

A production-grade identity layer. The pilot ran with a controlled cohort, which meant the question of proving unique, real personhood at scale, without surveillance, did not have to be solved. At any open scale it does. The next phase treats privacy-preserving identity as its central technical task.

Full-scale load and security assurance. The MVP was load-tested and security-reviewed at a baseline level appropriate to a prototype. A movement-scale deployment requires an independent contract audit, a professional penetration test, and an adversarial governance simulation. None of these were in scope for Milestone 3 or 4; all are scoped into the next phase.

Legal and regulatory review across jurisdictions. Token classification, data protection, and the legal status of decentralised participation vary across every jurisdiction in which Amnesty operates. The pilot did not commission cross-jurisdictional legal review. The next phase begins that work with a defined set of priority jurisdictions, drawing on Amnesty's own legal expertise alongside external counsel.

Naming these openly is not a weakness in the report. It is the difference between a proof of concept and a finished system, and it is the map of what the next phase must build.

10 DIGITAL RESILIENCE AND THE ROAD AHEAD

THE PRINCIPLE THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

A movement that defends human rights cannot build its future on infrastructure that violates them.

10.1 WHY THE PILOT CHANGES THE CONVERSATION

The pilot demonstrated that a Human Rights DAO can be made usable, understandable, and meaningful for participants who are not blockchain specialists. Participants successfully navigated governance flows, engaged with proposals, and reflected critically on questions of fairness, representation, and participation. The challenge ahead is therefore no longer whether a Human Rights DAO can be built. The pilot answered that question.

The more important question now is what infrastructure is required to operate such a system responsibly at larger scale.

Several findings point toward the next phase of work. Participants consistently highlighted the importance of trust, legitimacy, accessibility, and transparency. They also raised concerns around governance concentration, identity, inclusion, and accountability. These are not problems that can be solved through token design alone. They require a broader infrastructure approach that considers governance, identity, communications, storage, security, and participant protection together.

For a human rights organisation, these questions are particularly important. Amnesty operates in environments where surveillance, censorship, digital repression, and internet shutdowns increasingly affect civic participation. Any future governance system must therefore be designed not only for participation, but also for resilience.

The next phase of the HRDAO project focuses on that challenge: strengthening the infrastructure beneath the governance layer while preserving the accessibility and participation principles validated through the pilot. Future development must recognise that the material, political, and informational commons are increasingly under stress simultaneously, and design accordingly. The next phase takes this as a starting point rather than an afterthought.

THE DESIGN MANDATE

A human rights participation system must keep working through internet shutdowns, sanctions regimes, surveillance pressure, resource scarcity, and climate stress — often several at once. That means low-bandwidth and offline-capable design, decentralised hosting, secure identity handling, local-first computation, and no hard dependence on any single cloud, payment rail, or app-store chokepoint.

Amnesty International's 2026 briefing *Unlawful by Design* highlights significant concerns regarding privacy, consent, bias, and transparency within many contemporary generative AI systems. Future HRDAO development will therefore prioritise local and open-weight AI tools where practical, using them only for narrowly-defined assistive functions such as translation, accessibility support, and participant guidance. Human rights data should remain under the control of the communities generating it.

10.2 A RIGHTS-RESPECTING INFRASTRUCTURE STACK

The pilot successfully validated governance participation. The next phase focuses on the systems required to support that participation safely and sustainably.

At the intelligence layer, the project intends to move toward local and open-weight AI systems wherever practical. The goal is not to automate governance decisions, but to provide optional support functions such as translation, summarisation, accessibility assistance, and participant guidance. Running these systems locally or on infrastructure controlled by the movement reduces dependency on external platforms and improves transparency around data handling.

At the identity layer, the central challenge remains proving that participants are unique and eligible to participate without creating surveillance databases. Future work will explore decentralised identity systems, privacy-preserving credentials, and zero-knowledge approaches that allow participants to demonstrate eligibility while disclosing minimal personal information. Technologies within the Cardano ecosystem, including Atala PRISM and Midnight, provide potential pathways for further investigation.

At the communications layer, future development will prioritise secure and resilient communication channels that reduce dependence on single platforms. This includes encrypted communication, federated systems, and approaches capable of operating in constrained or disrupted environments.

At the storage layer, future work will continue exploring decentralised and censorship-resistant approaches for preserving governance records, participation histories, and evidence relevant to human rights activities. Long-term preservation is particularly important for movements whose work often involves documenting abuses and maintaining public memory over extended periods.

Finally, infrastructure decisions must recognise that participants have different risk profiles. Most users should be able to participate through familiar devices and interfaces. Higher-risk participants may require additional privacy, security, and operational protections. Appendix C outlines a tiered approach designed to accommodate these different contexts.

Taken together, these layers support a simple principle: governance systems intended for public-interest purposes should minimise unnecessary dependency while maximising transparency, resilience, and participant control.

10.3 GOVERNANCE BEYOND VOTING

One of the clearest lessons from the pilot is that voting alone is insufficient.

Participants consistently engaged with questions of fairness, representation, influence, and legitimacy. These concerns emerged before votes were cast, suggesting that governance quality depends as much on deliberation as on decision-making.

Future development should therefore explore structured deliberation mechanisms that help participants understand differing perspectives, identify areas of agreement, and refine proposals before formal voting occurs. The objective is not simply to count preferences, but to improve the quality of collective decision-making.

Several mature civic participation platforms offer useful reference points in this area. Projects such as Agora Citizen Network, Loomio, Decidim, and Pol.is have demonstrated approaches to consensus mapping, collaborative deliberation, and participatory governance at larger scales. While each operates in different contexts, they collectively highlight the value of discussion and sense-making prior to formal decision-making.

For HRDAO, the emerging model is increasingly clear: deliberation upstream, governance settlement downstream. Participants should have opportunities to understand issues, explore common ground, and refine proposals before governance outcomes are formalised through voting systems.

The pilot suggests that this approach may be particularly important in human rights contexts, where legitimacy depends not only on procedural fairness but also on meaningful participation.

10.4 CULTURE AS INFRASTRUCTURE

The pilot also reinforced a lesson often overlooked in technology projects: participation is cultural before it is technical.

Movements are sustained through stories, symbols, memory, creativity, and shared identity. Throughout history, cultural production has often functioned as political infrastructure in its own right. From

OSPAAAL's international solidarity networks, to Gran Fury's AIDS activism, to the collective visual practices of Taring Padi and the Lebanese uprising, cultural participation has helped communities communicate, educate, organise, and build collective agency.

The implication for HRDAO is straightforward. Participation systems should not be limited to voting interfaces and governance dashboards. They should also support storytelling, collective memory, creative expression, and the circulation of ideas across communities.

This insight aligns closely with the broader Manifest and Archive of Resistance work being developed alongside the project. Governance and memory are ultimately linked. Communities need both the ability to make decisions together and the ability to preserve the record of how those decisions emerged.

Future development should therefore treat culture as an operational component of participation rather than as a secondary communications function.

10.5 STRATEGIC DIRECTION

The pilot established a practical foundation for future work. The next phase is not about rebuilding the concept from scratch. It is about strengthening the systems required to support it responsibly.

The strategic direction is therefore to maintain Cardano as the governance and settlement layer while ensuring flexibility across identity, communications, storage, participation, and infrastructure layers. This approach allows the project to benefit from Cardano's research-driven governance architecture while avoiding unnecessary dependence on any single platform or service.

Future priorities are clear:

- strengthen governance design and deliberation processes
- develop privacy-preserving identity systems
- improve onboarding and governance literacy
- conduct independent security and scalability reviews
- expand testing cohorts and geographic reach
- continue open-source development and documentation
- build infrastructure that aligns with human rights principles

The pilot demonstrated that meaningful participatory governance is possible. The next phase focuses on creating the resilience, trust, and infrastructure required to support that participation over the long term.

This work remains exploratory, but the direction is now clearer. The question is no longer whether participatory governance can contribute to a human rights movement. The question is how to build the supporting systems responsibly, transparently, and at a scale capable of serving the communities such a movement exists to protect.

A tiered hardware approach is proposed, ranging from ordinary browser-based participation through to privacy-focused and high-risk configurations. Full guidance is provided in Appendix C.

THE NEXT PHASE IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Bring the intelligence home with local, open-weight AI. Solve identity with privacy-preserving cryptography rather than surveillance. Give participants and sections hardware they own and can repair. Communicate without being tracked. Make the record permanent. Connect through community-owned infrastructure. Deliberate before voting. Anchor the rights layer on Cardano, and keep everything above it open. That is the road ahead.

11 COMPARATORS AND THE WIDER FIELD

The HRDAO does not exist in isolation. A serious closeout situates the project against the others working on participatory governance and civic technology, both to learn from them and to be clear about what is distinctive here. The projects below are named as comparators and reference points. No partnership, integration, or collaboration is committed in this report; any such conversation would follow proper due diligence and Amnesty governance sign-off.

11.1 THE AGORA CITIZEN NETWORK

The most directly relevant comparator is the Agora Citizen Network, an open-source civic deliberation tool built in France and funded through the European Union's Next Generation Internet programme, with partners including UNESCO and the European Commission. Agora maps where participants agree and disagree, surfaces the proposals that bridge opinion groups, and does so with privacy-preserving identity proofs and a clearly-disclosed, European-built AI for summarisation. It has been used at national scale, including during France's national strike and UNESCO's Media and Information Literacy Week.

Two things make Agora instructive. First, its interface speaks the language of citizenship, not crypto — exactly the lesson David gave us in the pilot, operationalised at scale. Second, its deliberation-first, voting-second flow is the model the HRDAO's governance should follow. What the HRDAO has that a pure deliberation tool does not is an integrated layer of recognition and on-chain settlement: a way to reward participation and to make governance decisions durable and verifiable. The architectural pattern — deliberate upstream, settle downstream — is one the next phase will study on its merits.

11.2 LOOMIO, DECIDIM AND POL.IS

Three other tools define the field. Loomio, which has roots in Aotearoa New Zealand, is a mature consensus-focused decision tool used widely in cooperative and movement governance. Decidim, originally built for the city of Barcelona and now used by governments and institutions across Europe, is the most fully-featured participatory democracy platform in production. Pol.is, the opinion-mapping tool used in Taiwan's celebrated vTaiwan process, pioneered the consensus-detection approach that several newer tools now build on. Each offers lessons, and each is a candidate for evaluation as the deliberation layer matures. The HRDAO's distinctive contribution sits alongside them: it pairs deliberation with tokenised recognition and on-chain governance settlement in service of a single global movement.

12 RESULTS: KPIS, OUTPUTS, OUTCOMES AND IMPACT

While this pilot was intentionally limited in scale, the outcomes demonstrate that decentralised participation mechanisms can be adapted to a human rights context and successfully used by participants with little or no prior blockchain experience. The significance of the pilot lies not in transaction volume or token distribution alone, but in demonstrating that governance participation itself can be made visible, measurable, and accountable through open infrastructure.

This section sets the project's results out in the language of a results chain, so that what was put in, what was produced, what changed, and what it is expected to lead to can each be read on its own terms. It consolidates the evidence already presented in Sections 4 through 7 and Appendix B, and adds a forward view. Where Project Catalyst did not set a numeric target, the team set its own benchmark and has labelled it as such. Forecasts are clearly marked as projections, not commitments.

12.1 READING THE RESULTS: THE LOGIC MODEL

A results chain runs from inputs through activities to outputs, then to outcomes, then to impact. Inputs are the funding, people and partnerships committed to the work. Activities are what the project did with them. Outputs are the concrete things produced — a whitepaper, a model, a working system, a report. Outcomes are the changes those outputs caused in the short to medium term — what is now known, validated, or possible that was not before. Impact is the lasting contribution to Amnesty, to the Cardano ecosystem, and to the wider field. The forecast that closes the section carries the chain forward into the next phase, with each projection tied to the condition it depends on.

INPUTS AND ACTIVITIES, IN BRIEF

Inputs: A\$150,000 of Project Catalyst Fund 13 funding; the project team led by Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand with Manifest Studio; and the Amnesty and Cardano communities, over roughly eighteen months. Activities: governance research, dual-token design and economic simulation, MVP engineering, a four-region pilot, and this evaluation.

12.2 KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

The indicators below combine delivery metrics with the pilot's measured results. The pilot figures are drawn from 36 structured respondents across four regions, January to March 2026 (Appendix B).

INDICATOR	TARGET	RESULT	STATUS
Milestones accepted by Catalyst	4 of 4	4 of 4 (M4 in review)	On track
Budget delivered against milestones	A\$150,000	A\$125,000 released; A\$25,000 (M4) in review	On track
Open-source codebase published	Yes	Published to public repository	Met
Pilot participants (structured feedback)	≥30 (<i>team benchmark</i>)	36	Exceeded
Geographic reach	Multi-region (<i>benchmark</i>)	4 regions: NZ, AU, EU, Asia	Met
Experience rated smooth or intuitive	≥70% (<i>benchmark</i>)	83%	Exceeded
Would use a refined version	≥60% (<i>benchmark</i>)	78%	Exceeded
Usable with minimal onboarding	Yes (<i>benchmark</i>)	Yes (qualitative + 83%)	Met - 83% rated

INDICATOR	TARGET	RESULT	STATUS
		UX)	the experience smooth or intuitive following simple onboarding materials.
Substantive governance engagement	Signal sought	61% raised governance concerns	Strong signal
Results shared across Amnesty + Cardano	Yes	This report + network distribution	Met
Academic / peer outputs	≥1 (<i>benchmark</i>)	1 working paper + 3 accepted 2026 papers	Exceeded

Table 2. Key performance indicators against target.

Targets marked “benchmark” were set by the project team where Catalyst did not specify a numeric threshold. “M4 in review” reflects that this report is the deliverable under assessment.

12.3 OUTPUTS

Every output is public and is indexed, with its evidence location, in Appendix A.

OUTPUT	VERIFICATION SOURCE
Governance research and whitepaper (M1)	Whitepaper PDF, repository
Dual-token tokenomics model, simulation and contract specifications (M2)	Tokenomics model and technical report, repository
Working MVP — Aiken contracts, Vue/Gleam/TypeScript application, PostgreSQL, IPFS storage (M3)	/app, /smart-contracts, /e2e, /load-tests, repository
End-to-end, load and baseline-security test results (M3)	Test results, repository
Pilot feedback summary and dashboard (M3)	PILOT_FEEDBACK_SUMMARY / DASHBOARD, repository
This closeout and impact report, with Next Phase architecture (M4)	This document; Catalyst and network channels
Academic working paper and three accepted 2026 conference contributions	Section 12.7; venue records

Table 3. Outputs and verification.

12.4 OUTCOMES

Outcomes are the changes the outputs produced. Five are now demonstrable.

- **Usability outcome.** Supporters with no prior blockchain experience were able to successfully use the platform following minimal onboarding, demonstrating that decentralised governance can be made accessible beyond crypto-native communities. This was an open question at the start; it is now answered, and the 83 percent smooth-experience result is the evidence.
- **Economic-design outcome.** The dual-token model — transferable utility, non-transferable governance — held up under real use and demonstrated capture-resistance by keeping voting weight tied to contribution rather than capital.
- **Governance-agenda outcome.** The pilot surfaced the real risk set — concentration of influence, fairness of access, coordinated misalignment, and representation of lived experience — turning a vague “governance is hard” into a specific, prioritised design agenda.
- **Ecosystem outcome.** A reusable, open-source public-interest reference implementation now exists in the Cardano ecosystem, available to others building civic and humanitarian tools.

- **Knowledge outcome.** The work has entered the scholarly record, carrying its lessons beyond the project into the wider research community (Section 12.7).

12.5 IMPACT

The project's impact is threefold. For Amnesty, it produced a working, tested demonstration that decentralised governance can serve the movement, along with a clear-eyed map of what it would take to do this at scale. For the Cardano ecosystem, it produced a substantial public-interest use case — open-source contracts, documentation, and economic modelling that others building civic and humanitarian tools can learn from and build upon. For the wider field of participatory governance, it added a carefully-documented case study in making decentralised participation usable by people who care about a cause rather than a technology. For participants, the project provided a tangible opportunity to engage with governance concepts, explore new forms of participation, and contribute directly to the development of future public-interest governance systems.

12.6 FORECASTED IMPACT AHEAD

The following are **projections for the next phase, not commitments**. Each is a planning figure expressed as a range and tied to the condition it depends on — above all, securing funding for the next phase through the diversified portfolio described in Section 12.9. They are offered so that the next phase can be measured against a clear, honest baseline rather than an open-ended ambition.

FORWARD INDICATOR	PROJECTION	HORIZON / CONDITION
Pilot participants at next scale	300–1,000 (roughly 10–30× the pilot)	Y1–Y2; refined platform + funding
Amnesty sections piloting the sovereign operator stack	2–5 sections	Y1–Y2; section interest + hardware funding
Independent security audit + penetration test	Completed and published	Y1; precondition for open deployment
Privacy-preserving identity layer (PRISM + Midnight ZK)	Working prototype	Y1–Y2; central technical task
Deliberation-upstream / settle-downstream flow	Integrated and tested	Y1; builds on existing on-chain voting
Open security & hardware playbook	Published openly	Y1; low dependency, high value
Languages supported for participation	5–10	Y1–Y2; community translation layer
Funding secured (three-legged portfolio)	Next-phase budget secured	Y1; grants + Amnesty + Cardano follow-on
Per-action compute footprint	Lower than a cloud-LLM baseline	Ongoing; local-first, small-model design

Table 4. Forecasted impact ahead (projections, next 12–24 months, funding-dependent).

ASSUMPTIONS AND THE GATING RISK

These projections assume funding for the next phase is secured against the diversified portfolio in Section 12.9; figures are planning ranges, not guarantees. The single gating risk is the identity layer: proving unique, real personhood at open scale without surveillance is the hardest unsolved problem, and the participation and section-scaling projections above depend on progress against it.

12.7 SCHOLARLY AND PRESENTATION CONTRIBUTION

The thinking behind the HRDAO has been developed into academic contributions that both strengthen the project's intellectual foundation and carry its lessons into the wider research community. The governance model is set out in a working paper, *From Token Ownership to Participation: Rethinking DAO Governance*

in Public-Interest Contexts (Farry and Samsudin, 2025); the project lead publishes academic work under the name Gareth Farry. Building on it, the project's research has been accepted for presentation at three international venues in 2026.

- **Aarhus University — Democracy and Digital Citizenship** (SHAPE, Aarhus, August 2026): a paper on participation, collective memory, and the infrastructures of resistance, connecting the HRDAO to the Archive of Resistance and arguing that democratic legitimacy depends on participation and memory together.
- **Solidarity AI** (Platform Cooperativism Consortium, Chulalongkorn University, Bangkok, November 2026): a contribution on participation-based governance within the conference's framing of cooperative "solidarity stacks" and AI built for climate justice, communal care, and local values rather than extraction.
- **4S TechnoPower** (Society for Social Studies of Science, fiftieth-anniversary meeting, Toronto, October 2026): a contribution engaging the conference's central question of who holds power over technoscientific futures, asking who counts as a public and who holds authority over the civic infrastructure that convenes it.
- **Conference Presentations** Presented at **RightsCon** (Taipei) on digitally archiving human rights using blockchain infrastructure. Presented at **Blockchain For Good Summit** on reimagining public sector governance through DAOs. Presented at **Bread&Net UnConference** on a blockchain framework for human rights accountability. Presented at **Reimagining Fundraising APAC Summit** on blockchain tools for human rights fundraising.

These contributions situate the HRDAO within established scholarship, practitioner networks, and international conference ecosystems concerned with recursive publics, the commons, decentralised governance, soulbound credentials, digital memory, and contribution-based legitimacy. Through both research and public engagement, the project has explored how blockchain technologies can support more transparent, participatory, and accountable forms of civic coordination. Together, these activities advance a thesis the pilot bears out: that the legitimacy of a digital public rests on two intertwined conditions, participatory authority over collective decisions and verifiable stewardship of the public's own record, memory, and shared history.

12.8 RECOMMENDATIONS

The recommendations follow directly from what the pilot taught us.

- Treat governance design as the primary work of the next phase, with structured deliberation placed upstream of formal voting, and with explicit mechanisms against concentration of influence.
- Move the intelligence layer to local, open-weight AI under the movement's control, and publish the rationale and the data-handling policy openly.
- Solve privacy-preserving identity as the central technical task, building on Atala PRISM and Midnight and evaluating portable, zero-knowledge identity proofs.
- Design inclusion in from the start, with multiple equally-valued paths to participation including low-bandwidth, offline, and assisted routes.
- Commission an independent security audit, a professional penetration test, and an adversarial governance simulation before any move toward open deployment.
- Begin cross-jurisdictional legal review across a defined set of priority jurisdictions, drawing on Amnesty's own legal expertise alongside external counsel.
- Publish security and hardware guidance openly, including guidance for high-risk participants, in the tradition of Access Now, Internews and the Electronic Frontier Foundation.

12.9 FUNDING PATHWAYS

The next phase is designed to be funded from a diverse base rather than any single source, which both reduces risk and matches the project's values. Credible pathways include open-source and internet-infrastructure funders such as the NLnet Foundation and the European Union's Next Generation Internet programme, which already funds comparable work; digital-rights and open-society funders such as the Open Technology Fund, Internews, the Internet Society Foundation, and the Mozilla Foundation; human rights funders aligned with Amnesty's mission; cooperative and regenerative finance pathways; further Cardano Project Catalyst rounds and Cardano Foundation support for specific technical workstreams; and Amnesty's own digital innovation and section-level pathways. The recommended portfolio draws roughly a third from grants, a third from Amnesty-internal and partner-section funding, and a third from Cardano-ecosystem follow-on — a three-tiered approach by design, so that no single pathway carries the project.

12.10 STAKEHOLDER REFLECTIONS

Throughout the pilot, participants consistently demonstrated that they understood the broader governance implications of the platform rather than focusing solely on technical features. Their reflections reinforced both the strengths of the MVP and the design challenges that remain for future development.

Several participants highlighted the accessibility and usability of the platform:

"Really easy to use, clear, intuitive, and functional... especially on mobile, it's easy to navigate and understand how points are accumulated."

"Overall easy to use and understand... it very much feels like an Amnesty product in terms of design."

Others focused on the participatory potential of the model itself:

"I think this could significantly increase participation and influence... the tool has the potential to powerfully democratise the perspectives of thousands of users."

"I would. The idea of being able to participate in online governance for an organisation I care about is really exciting."

Participants also identified governance questions that will shape future development:

"A small number of users gaining a large number of DAO points could have an outsized influence."

"How do we ensure this tool can uphold the views of people with lived experience?"

"What would happen if a group used the DAO to push for an agenda that is antithetical to Amnesty's values?"

Rather than viewing these concerns as weaknesses, the project team considers them evidence of meaningful engagement. Participants moved beyond interface feedback and engaged directly with questions of legitimacy, representation, inclusion, and accountability. This reinforces one of the pilot's central findings: the primary challenge ahead is governance design rather than technology implementation.

Taken together, stakeholder feedback suggests there is genuine interest in more participatory forms of engagement within the Amnesty movement, provided future development continues to prioritise transparency, accessibility, inclusion, and trust.

We also received feedback from Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand Executive Director Jacqui Dillon as follows:

"The Human Rights DAO pilot has demonstrated that emerging governance technologies can be explored in a way that remains aligned with Amnesty's values of participation, transparency and accountability."

This Human Rights DAO initiative remains at the forefront of Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand's strategic investment in the enablement and protection of human rights through decentralised technologies. Additionally, a regional project team is now being assembled as we seek to extend our pilot as a SEA regional enabler of governance, campaign activation, movement building and human rights accountability levers. The prize - democratisation of power of evidence, people and voice for social, political and economic change.

and project development team Ben Turea at Matou.nz:

“We’re excited about the opportunity to continue working with you and Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand in future developments.”

Public Notification:

Project outputs and findings have been disseminated through Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand communication channels, including the Amnesty Human Rights DAO project page <https://amnesty.org.nz/dao/>, LinkedIn, international conference presentations, the public GitHub repository, and the Project Catalyst milestone platform. These dissemination activities ensure that project findings, technical outputs, governance research, and future recommendations remain publicly accessible to both the Amnesty movement and the wider civic technology community.

Conference presentations include:

Aarhus University — Democracy and Digital Citizenship, Solidarity AI, 4S TechnoPower, RightsCon 2025, Blockchain For Good Summit, Bread&Net UnConference, Reimagining Fundraising APAC Summit.

13 CONCLUSION

THE CONVERSATION IS JUST BEGINNING

A milestone report can be a box to tick or a contribution to make. This pilot earned the right to be a contribution.

It showed that supporters who have never touched a blockchain will pick up a governance tool and use it without a tutorial. It showed that recognition makes participation feel real. It showed that the people who care about human rights will engage with the hard questions of governance more seriously than most experts. And it showed, in the asking of those questions, exactly what the next phase must build.

The road ahead is not about proving the concept again. It is about doing it at the standard a human rights movement deserves: with intelligence the movement owns, identity that protects rather than exposes, hardware that lasts and can be repaired, communication that cannot be quietly tapped, a record that cannot be quietly erased, and governance designed so that the loudest and the wealthiest do not drown out the people with the most at stake.

None of that is finished. All of it is now buildable, and the foundation is laid. The most important outcome of the project is therefore not the software itself, but the evidence that supporters are willing and able to participate meaningfully when governance systems are designed around transparency, contribution, and trust. The pilot established a practical foundation for future experimentation. The responsibility now is to ensure that future development remains aligned with the movement's commitment to participation, transparency, privacy, and human rights. That is what the next phase is for.

A EVIDENCE AND REPOSITORY INDEX

All project outputs are public. The canonical repository holds the code, contracts, documentation, and milestone evidence.

EVIDENCE AND REPOSITORY INDEX

Project Repository:

<https://github.com/Sugarlicks/AmnestyDAO-Token>

The following repository contains all major project outputs, technical documentation, stakeholder feedback, tokenomics research, MVP source code, smart contract development, pilot testing evidence, and evaluation materials produced throughout the Catalyst project lifecycle.

Acceptance Criterion	Repository Evidence
Governance research and whitepaper	WHITEPAPER FINAL-1300018-AmnestyDAOandHRT.pdf
Project planning documentation	Catalyst HRDAO Project plan 7.25.pdf
Stakeholder engagement and consultation	HRDAO Stakeholder Engagement Record & Feedback
Stakeholder feedback summary	HRDAO – Stakeholder Feedback Summary.pdf
Tokenomics model and technical report	Tokenomics Model and Technical Report/
Tokenomics simulations and sustainability modelling	Tokenomics Model and Technical Report/
Smart contract architecture	smart-contracts/
Technical audit documentation	audits/
MVP application source code	app/
MVP pilot testing evidence	milestone-3-evidence/
Pilot participant feedback	PILOT_FEEDBACK_SUMMARY.pdf
Project documentation and implementation notes	README.md and HRDAO README.md
Team onboarding and project governance	Team OnBoarding Letter - 1300018.pdf
Catalyst approval documentation	Approval Letter - Funding DAO Project
Final Milestone 4 Evaluation Report	HRDAO_Milestone4_Closeout_Report.pdf
Final Project Video – YouTube	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3yMPATiJ4mg

Repository Structure Overview

/AmnestyDAO-token

- ├── Tokenomics Model and Technical Report/
- ├── app/
- ├── audits/
- ├── milestone-3-evidence/
- ├── smart-contracts/
- ├── WHITEPAPER FINAL-1300018-AmnestyDAOandHRT.pdf
- ├── HRDAO – Stakeholder Feedback Summary.pdf
- ├── PILOT_FEEDBACK_SUMMARY.pdf
- ├── Catalyst HRDAO Project plan 7.25.pdf
- ├── README.md
- └── HRDAO_Milestone4_Closeout_Report.pdf

This repository serves as the permanent public record of the project and contains all major outputs required under Catalyst Fund 13 Project 1300018.

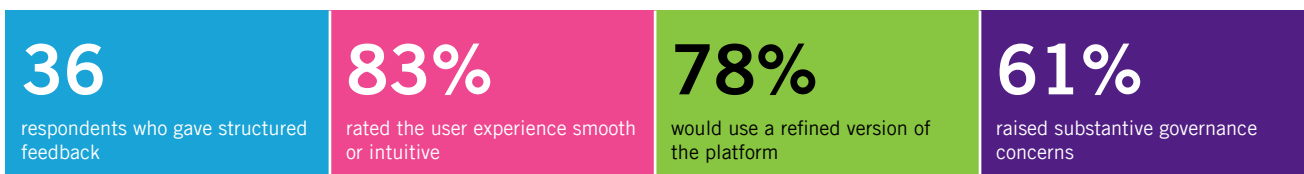
Dissemination Evidence

Location

Amnesty project page	https://amnesty.org.nz/dao/
Public repository	GitHub repository - https://github.com/Sugarlicks/AmnestyDAO-Token/tree/main https://www.linkedin.com/feed/update/urn:li:share:7473134381713412096
LinkedIn announcement	https://www.linkedin.com/posts/pdsmithmba_decentralised-autonomous-organisation-dao-share-7472673169292759040-SzFM/
Conference presentations	RightsCon, Blockchain For Good Summit, Bread&Net, Reimagining Fundraising APAC Summit
Catalyst milestone platform	Project 1300018 - https://projectcatalyst.io/funds/13/cardano-use-cases-concept/amnesty-international-dao-and-human-rights-token-proof-of-concept-10-million-global-membership-community

B PILOT FEEDBACK DASHBOARD

Source: HRDAO MVP pilot, January to March 2026, 36 structured respondents across Aotearoa New Zealand, Australia, the European Union and Asia.



Recurring strengths: intuitive mobile-first experience; strong alignment with Amnesty's identity; a rewarding and motivating participation loop; conceptual power of the model.

Recurring refinement themes: clearer token-spending and impact visibility; gentle onboarding to the DAO concept; a web option alongside the app; richer interaction over time.

Governance themes for the next phase: concentration of influence; fairness of access; protection against misaligned coordinated actors; representation of people with lived experience.

C TIERED HARDWARE AND SOFTWARE KIT

This guidance is published openly, following the practice of Access Now, Internews and the Electronic Frontier Foundation, who publish high-risk security guidance on the open web because withholding it does not protect the people who need it. Costs are indicative and for planning only.

TIER 1 — EVERYDAY SUPPORTER

Existing personal phone or computer; the HRDAO web app in any modern browser. Optional hardware security key for account protection. Indicative cost: none.

TIER 2 — PRIVACY-CONSCIOUS SUPPORTER

A de-Googled smartphone running an open mobile operating system, available pre-configured from specialist vendors; encrypted email and VPN; a hardware security key. Optional small mesh-radio device for those involved in protest or remote work. Indicative cost: USD 800–1,400.

TIER 3 — AMNESTY SECTION / OPERATOR

A repairable, modular laptop running Linux; a paired privacy phone; a self-hosted server appliance under the section's physical control, running its own storage, local AI, and network services; two hardware security keys; a small mesh-networking kit for protest coordination. Indicative cost per section: USD 3,500–5,500.

TIER 4 — HIGH-RISK PARTICIPANT / FRONTLINE ACTIVIST

All Tier 3 components, plus: operational security training delivered through a practitioner with frontline experience; an air-gapped device used only for signing, never connected to the internet; a hardware wallet with a passphrase-protected hidden account so that a coerced search reveals only a decoy; a documented, peer-reviewed personal threat model agreed with the supporting Amnesty section; and a clear protocol for a compromise of the device, the person, or the network. This tier is assembled per individual against a specific threat profile, never procured in bulk.

Open resources every high-risk participant should know: Access Now Digital Security Helpline (24/7, free, multilingual, accessnow.org/help); Internews SAFETAG framework (safetag.org); the Electronic Frontier Foundation's Surveillance Self-Defense guides (ssd.eff.org); and Tactical Tech's Holistic Security manual. The individual threat models for Tier 4 participants are confidential by definition; this kit guidance is not.

D REFERENCES AND ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Amnesty International sources. *The State of the World's Human Rights* (Amnesty International Annual Report 2026, POL 10/0320/2026); *Unlawful by Design: Exposing the Human Rights Costs of Generative AI* (Amnesty International, POL 40/0996/2026, May 2026); the Amnesty International Algorithmic Accountability Lab; Amnesty's Surveillance Watch platform; and the Amnesty International Visual Identity Toolkit.

Project sources. The project's own Milestone 1 whitepaper, Milestone 2 tokenomics model and technical report, and Milestone 3 MVP, pilot feedback summary and dashboard; and the working paper *From Token Ownership to Participation: Rethinking DAO Governance in Public-Interest Contexts* (Farry and Samsudin, 2025).

Context and evidence base. Richardson et al., *Earth beyond six of nine planetary boundaries* (2023) and the 2025 Planetary Health Check (Stockholm Resilience Centre); Freedom House, *Freedom in the World 2025*; Access Now, *KeepItOn: Internet Shutdowns in 2025*, and its research on sanctions and digital rights; OHCHR documentation on digital repression in Iran and Myanmar; and the Berkeley Protocol on Digital Open Source Investigations.

Civic technology and scholarship. Publicly-documented work by the Agora Citizen Network, Loomio, Decidim, Pol.is, Access Now, Internews, and the Electronic Frontier Foundation; and scholarship on participatory governance and cultural infrastructure including Ostrom on the commons, Fraser on the public sphere, Kelty on recursive publics, Ohlhaber, Weyl and Buterin on soulbound tokens, Meissner on cultural politics, and the histories of OSPAAAL, Gran Fury, Taring Padi, and digital activism that inform the project's approach to culture as infrastructure.

With thanks to the thirty-six pilot participants whose candid, critical, and generous feedback shaped both this evaluation and the road ahead, and to the Amnesty International Aotearoa New Zealand community and the Cardano Project Catalyst community for their support of this work.